

CUTTING EDGE SOLUTIONS

BUSINESS PLAN

Home Management Systems



CUTTING EDGE SOLUTIONS
Technology for the Future
1323 SE 17th Street, #343
Ft. Lauderdale, FL 33316
steveww@bellsouth.net
Contact: Stephen Calhoun

Cutting Edge Solutions

1323 SE 17th Street, #343
Fort Lauderdale, FL 33316
(954) 462-1607

Principals:
Stephen Calhoun
Douglas Calhoun
Glenn Govoni
Adam ??

Copy Number: 1

Executive Summary

How do we take this computer technology today and actually put it to work making life easier for us. Computers are the biggest technology trend to hit the World since the telephone, television, and VCR. There is one difference between a computer and the fore-mentioned items…ease of use. It takes the average individual many classes, a few computer books or having the right friend to learn how to use a computer to make life simpler for them. But, is it actually making life simpler?

Microsoft has recently moved down the road towards putting applications (i.e. Word, Excel) on the Internet to be accessed, instead of installed inside of everybody's PC. Why is this??? In the next 2 years, 75% of computer-users in the cities and rural communities will have high-speed Internet access. What better way to sell somebody a product then directly thru the Internet with a monthly usage fee? Users would not have to download the latest updates or wait days for their new software to arrive in the mail. The latest and greatest business and recreational software will be available immediately for our use. The high-speed connection is bringing new forms of technology into the home very quickly. Refrigerators will be equipped with barcode scanners and will make your grocery list for you and send it to the local store for delivery and they will also alert you to food that is spoiling or outdated. Your alarm clock will start the coffee maker. Your cellphone will turn up the A/C and turn on the lights as you get close to. These technologies are all amazing and wonderful but isn't the computer supposed to free our spare time so we can spend more time with family, the kids or enjoying our passions. We spend much of our time learning how to manipulate the Internet to get what we need out of it. We spend more time on the phone waiting on hold for utility and sales representatives every day. We spend hours a month writing out checks to pay bills. Why can't we have everything done for us within one Internet browser window and why can't we have courtesy that every consumer deserves?

Imagine sitting down at the computer the week before your moving into your new home and ordering all of your utilities (i.e. Electricity, Phone, Gas, Rubbish, Cable, Internet, Security, etc) online with just entering your Name, address, phone numbers and SSN just once…no more waiting 20 minutes on the phone for each service. How about clicking a few check boxes and ordering pizza, a new lawn-mowing service and a pool cleaner in just a few minutes. How about paying all of those bills at once or at specified times during the month with just a few clicks. How about checking all of your email and spending a few minutes checking out the latest pictures posted to the family web site from your family members. Does this sound like a fantasy or the next step in online communications? These computers would finally free up our time from the mundane chores that consume our days.

Company Description

Cutting Edge Solutions (CES) main objective is to provide conveniences to individuals and families using the Internet; therefore, saving time and money. The desire of CES is to provide these conveniences with an easy interface, and a customer support team that is courteous and knowledgeable. This Business Plan will show that there is a need for a new generation of Internet business.

Mission Statement:

"I've had enough" were my own words the last time I got off the phone with another ungrateful sales representative for another Internet company. CES needs to show people that the Internet can be a powerful and useful tool, that can finally provide the conveniences that everybody has hyped about the last 5 years. My sole intention with this business is to design a company that people will be happy with and enjoy using it's products. "People", meaning customers and employees.

Company goals and objectives:

CES needs to bring consumers a way of compiling all of their gadgets and useful web sites into one powerful business solution. What consumer would not be intrigued by saving money and cutting hours out of their daily chores of taking care of common households needs? The objective is to provide these consumers with a platform that is stable as a television set, easy to use like a toaster and as convenient as running water.

Business philosophy:

The most important thing in business these days is to make your employees comfortable and happy with the job that they are performing. Upbeat employee moral and positive attitudes will compliment their performance when it comes to dealing with the customers, who call to find a helping hand and someone to sympathize with their individual problems.

Business Summary:

This business and software product will me initially marketed to a testing group of handpicked consumers. Their feedback and improvements ideas will help to design the business further. The market will grow from these individuals to the local city, county and eventually state and country.

The Information Technology (IT) industry has had its share of ups and downs in the last few years. We have gone from a Bull Market to a moderate technology depression and many companies have not made the cut. The "weeding" out of these companies has helped to show which companies will stand the test of time and which ones are built upon a rock solid foundation. Internet start-ups based upon ideas with no initial income

projection has shown the Venture Capitalists that this industry is like any other business industry. In order to succeed in the market, you need a company based upon an exciting, functional product, excellent customer service and proper financial advising.

CES is not another business idea, but an improvement upon many common business practices. The IT industry has shown itself what people will buy and what people will use. The IT industry has also shown what people are frustrated with and the hype has disappointed many individuals after their use of these products. CES intends to overshadow these stereotypes, start from the beginning and build a technology starting from scratch with a positive approach and a typical business solution that was common 5, 20, 50 years ago before the Internet revolution hit. These changes in the way Internet business is done will be a guiding light upon future companies and it is CES's hope that we can be an example of simple thinking and common goals which should be set throughout the IT industry. "A faithful heart makes every wish come true"*

This is a growing industry that needs change and a new foresight to make things happen. Cutting Edge Solutions (CES) was founded in 1998 with an idea in mind that people need friendly and proper, training, service and products. Today's technological age is moving at a fast pace where the average American still only knows how to use an ATM. The other millions of American's with their newfound computer skills are trying to catch up with the rampant computer race. CES was designed to properly interface people with technology. Homeowners still do not recognize how involved computers, and everyday technology has become. CES will incorporate the latest in Electronics with the power of the Graphical User Interface and provide a product that will be simple to use and powerful in productivity.

CES will succeed because of the visions of many individuals, not just one. It is the individual who has the great ideas, but doesn't have a way of using them or giving these ideas to anyone to be put to use. This company will grow from determination and visions that are made possible by the acquaintances that we have today and by the new employees and partners we will make in the future. Our strength will be based upon common goals, a realization of the weaknesses that our competitors show and by the friendship and bonding which will hold our company and people together.

Personal Philosophy:

My personal philosophy/quote is "Why use my skills to continue to alter the environment when I can use them to help show humanity what we have to preserve". We are now starting to see various IT companies becoming involved in the protection of our environment. Computers and their components are now being recycled, as huge stores of outdated hardware is being thrown away. I always vowed that if I had the chance to make a difference, my expertise and skills would be used towards the protection of our environment. I once considered applying to the Environmental Protection Agency as a step towards this goal. I believe the best way to make a difference is thru communication. The best way to communicate is through media and the Internet these days, therefore, with every aspect of the way I do business, I would like to look at the possibilities of

combining our services with the protection of the environment, such as helping to remove recyclable products from households which do not have a community recycling plan.

My background has been quite diversified over the past 20 years, from skiing to computers, from yachting to Computer Aided Drafting, but the common idea's from each of these industries is Customer Satisfaction, Values and Honesty. My three words of ambition are "Stars, Faith and Integrity". The Stars are what we must aim for and we cannot get there without trying. My Faith is what I hold dearly while bringing these ideas to paper and the people. The biggest word of all is Integrity. I realize that there is a chance that I might succeed beyond my wildest dreams, but I never want these dreams and success to be only mine. I want to share with all the people that help me get there and to give back richly to society and mother nature what I don't need. Growing up in the state of Maine has taught me the importance of family values, the necessity of being polite and kind, and the frailty of our environment. We should consider each of these notions at every step we take in the building of this business.

I have always followed this industry and have made many predictions…..
????

Introduction:

Picture this on a typical weekday:
You load your coffee maker the night before, hop into bed, hit the touch panel to turn all house lights off, except your bedroom, arm the security system and turn on your alarm clock including the setting of your morning wake-up music, the thermostat gets set to the appropriate level and your home/cell phones are set to mute. The system checks for open windows or doors, checks to see if the dog or cat is in the house and make sure that all appliances (stereo, tv, computer, ceiling fans) are in power saving mode or turned off, the dishwasher is scheduled to start during the night and you can double check for your next day reminders/appointments. You pick up your new book (downloaded wirelessly) on a folding screen in the shape of a hardback novel (but lighter in weight) which would open to the last page read by yourself, your spouse or others. One more touch of the panel and the bedroom lights are turned off.

Next Morning:

6:00am: Thermostat is turned to appropriate level, security system is shutdown and the dog and cat bowls are auto filled with food and water. Appropriate funds are automatically being transferred to accounts for Utility bills that are due that day.

6:15am: The alarm music rises slowly to wake you. Lights are turned up softly for awakening but not to awaken your partner. Touch the panel briefly and alarm is set to snooze or reset for wife's future awakening, and the coffee maker starts. Lights are on in the bathroom, music turned on low and temperature level set to a comfortable setting for your shower. If the motion sensor in the bathroom does not sense any movement then you've overslept and the alarm process will start again. Short list of daily reminders/ appointments is on screen in bathroom or shower for daily planning and clothing decision while showering and shaving. Empty can of shaving cream thrown into wastebasket where it is bar code scanned upon entry and added to computerized shopping list.

6:30am: Arrive in the kitchen; lights come on automatically to your arrival. Alarm and light settings start for the children. Pet door unlocks to allow the dog and cat out. Enjoy your hot coffee with plenty of sugar, milk and cereal available thanks to that automatic shopping list. Kitchen touch panel displays CNN, which appears in one corner and your daily appointments in another along with email and voicemail alerts for all phones. Other corners can be security cameras, child monitors, home alert devices (hot water system, plumbing system, hvac system, propane levels), and grocery list. One of the alerts is the refrigerator telling you that the chicken, that you had the refrigerator automatically defrost last week, is now spoiled. Remove the chicken and discard (automatically added to grocery list). Enjoy your breakfast while watching the news and checking/replying to your emails. Empty the dishwasher while carrying on a speakerphone conversation with business partner who needed your early morning advice. A reminder flashes on the screen to make sure that the children have headed out to the curbside as the school bus has just been sensed starting down your street.

Tap the touch panel to alert the system that you will be departing soon. Your car is started automatically (shuts off in 5 minutes if you have not entered vehicle or if Carbon Monoxide emissions reach unsafe level within garage due to ventilation failure) and car temperature level automatically set depending upon outside temperature. As you leave the house, one more tap of the panel brings up a friendly reminder that you need to take your gym clothes with you for a racquetball game later that day and shows you that you have not let the dog and cat back in. As the door shuts, it is locked and security system is reset to proper level for wife's awakening, kitchen lights and coffee maker are shut off. Upon entering your car and the closing of your door, the garage door is lifted, seatbelt reminder and weather alerts are spoken to you along with traffic advisories and a new GPS programmed route, which will bypass any traffic congestion on your way to the office for the day.
8:00am:

Services:

CES has dreams about what the future should hold for households of tomorrow, but trying to encompass such a broad spectrum of services from the start would require extraordinary capital, research and marketing. Therefore, we intend to focus on the key to this future which is the customer service / membership portion of the business. We would provide the website technology and membership which would bring all of these services together. As the company grows, partnerships will be researched and considered for further expansion. You will find many other ideas listed below as to what CES can offer, but the realization is that the introduction and perfection of one service must be accomplished before straying to these other ideas.

The major products of what CES has to offer for service has been skirted up until this point. The intention was to create a mindset and understanding of where technology is right now and where technology is heading. CES will be a pseudo brokerage house for all forms of contractors in the home service industry.

Here are some examples of what industries we can broker for:

Rent	Fuel for Vehicles	Car Repair
Security	Pool Cleaning	Car Detailing
Cellphone	Landscaping	House Cleaning
Telephone	Plumbers	Voicemail
Water & Trash	Child Care	
Cable	Carpenters	FedEx
Misc. (Storage)	Physicians	Tracking
Electricity	Health Monitoring	Online
Home Natural Gas	and elderly care	Training

CES will create a pool of contractors within each industry group listed above and negotiate for lower fees for these services based upon the common business practice of Bulk Buying. These limited partnerships with such business will allow CES to offer the

convenience of taking care of the many household requirements from one website location, and to properly track these schedules and combine payments for ease of use. The customer can change the contractor they use with the click of a button instead of a face-to-face confrontation, which so many people feel uncomfortable with. The customer can order new services quickly and easily, and view their budget simultaneously.

CES will charge a monthly fee of $9.95 for this service and will also collect revenue from the resale of the contract services. The addition of selling or brokering wireless, home automation hardware and services will be a future monthly fee.

This service will be brought to the home thru a website that can be customized by the customer to allow them access to only the information and options that the need. This web site should be graphically pleasing, user-friendly and consist of music or sounds that make the experience enjoyable, instead of feeling industrial. A friendly web-site appearance, feedback from other customers, and an intuitive user interface will make our customers feel comfortable while making their purchases.

There are so many other products and services that can be developed and incorporated into CES's product. The future will bring categorized, popular websites for common consumer searches such as: recipes, home improvements, etc. Online shopping will find the lowest prices from a huge database of distributors (similar to Storerunner.com or MySimon.com). Instead of searching the various price comparison companies, we would be offering one location for the customers search. We can sell bar code scanners and bar coded stickers for labeling food items or other misc. household items to make sure that they get added to the grocery purchasing side of the software upon there disposal.

We can develop relationships with online shopping companies to allow our consumers access to the most popular shopping sites. Online video rental and pizza ordering are amongst the various business aspects that we can bring to our customers. The customized appearance of the customers website would allow them to choose what grocery stores do they like, which video or music service do they prefer. Which movie theatre and restaurants do they visit most often and have the ability to make reservations online? How can they save money on their cable bill by receiving entertainment thru the Internet connection? They can post pictures of the family and update the family calendar and contacts. Future connections to hotel, air & car reservations would be available. The list goes on but our main focus for the starting of this company is the contractor brokerages.

Competitive Advantages and Disadvantages:

The development of this company will be based solely on the vision of the employees. As there happens to be no other company currently operating that we can compare or model ourselves to, this will be a creative challenge, but will also be an advantage as we are developing the next generation of Internet business. The communication of the

uniqueness of our service and products to our consumers will be key in deciding of CES's future.

Marketing Plan

As quoted from the Fort Lauderdale Chamber of Commerce web-site:

"The Greater Ft. Lauderdale Chamber of Commerce sits geographically in the center of the Internet Coast of South Florida. This is the hottest location for technology-related businesses and enterprises. It is an ideal location for multinational corporations, technology companies, service providers and any type of business that is looking to be connected to global markets by land, sea, air, satellite or fiber-optic cable. Not only is the area the birthplace of the PC but also is the application Service Provider (ASP) capital of the U.S. and now boasts of over 6,000 high-tech companies."

"The Internet industry is pushing South Florida into its own meteoric rise on an international scale. Economic boards, universities, industry leaders and venture capitalists have teamed up to launch South Florida's three counties - Broward, Palm-Beach, and Miami-Dade - into a prominent position on the world map of the Internet, branding the area the "Internet Coast." The leading organizations of the Internet Coast movement include The Broward Alliance, Miami/Dade's Beacon Council, and the Palm Beach Business Development Board. The Internet Coast is a grassroots movement being fueled by a natural progression of events in Southeast Florida, the original birthplace of the IBM PC."

Fort Lauderdale has been the site for the birth of various Internet companies as this city of ambitious consumers welcomes new products and ideas. South Florida has great weather, no personal income tax a relatively low cost of living. There are over 200 dot-com business that call South Florida home and have impressed upon the people here that South Florida is an emerging area of new technology. The consumers are used to new technology and welcome the opportunity to test these new technologies.

"The Broward County economy gives birth to between 8 and 10 percent of its locally owned businesses each year. Typically, half of these new ventures survives beyond

their infancy and become part of the County's longer-range economic base. While the Broward Alliance has only a limited role in encouraging new business formations, it has a stronger role in creating a climate favorable to entrepreneurs and in supporting the growth of young firms in export-oriented industries. In fact, the Broward Alliance's most important mission is the facilitation of business climate improvements that improve make the County a more competitive location for existing and new business investment." as quoted by The Broward County Alliance web-site.

Economics:

Yahoo reported that:

"Online advertising spending is expected to grow from $4.2 million at the end of 1999 to $25.4 million by 2003."

"The internet grew at a faster rate than any other advertising media in 1999. It showed a 116% increase over 1998, while cable TV increased by 20% and outdoor by 13%."

Other finding's have shown similar statistics in Online Advertising:

US: Online Advertiser Spending by Product/Service ($ billions)

	2000	2005
Financial Services	1.1	2.8
Automotive	0.3	2.1
Media	0.8	1.5
Computer Hardware and Software	0.7	1.4
Classified Listings	0.4	1.4
Consumer packaged goods	0.1	1.1
Travel	0.3	1.0
Health	0.2	0.9
Telecommunications	0.3	0.8
Other	1.2	3.9
Total Online Advertising	5.3	16.5

Source: Jupiter Communications, August 2000

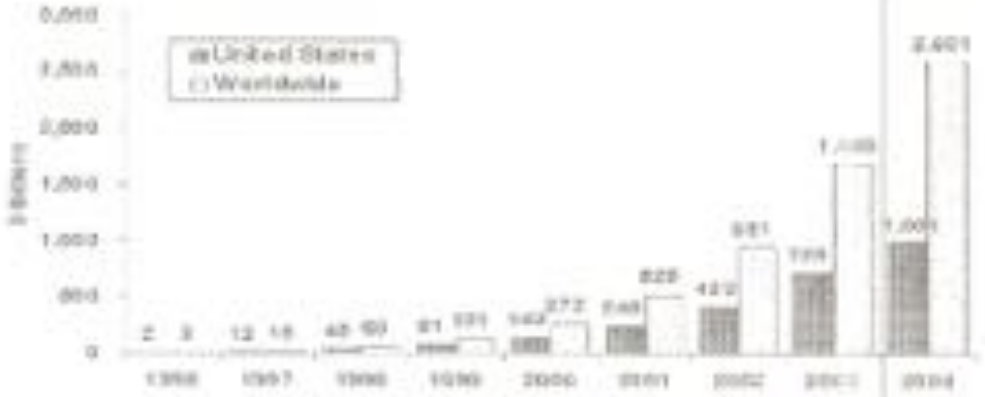
Online Spending is on the rise as well:

In a report from America Online on May 23, 2001:

"AOL says its members spent about $6.7 billion during the first quarter of 2001, an increase of nearly 70 percent over the same period a year ago. First-quarter spending also topped the $6.4 billion spent during the previous quarter, including the holiday season. Ascolere, an Arlington, Va.-based market research firm, estimates 17 million, about three quarters of the Vienna, Va.-based ISP's members, now shop online.

Tracking its members' purchases, AOL says the most significant increases came in furniture sales, tickets for sporting events, clothing and groceries."

Total Internet Commerce Revenue
- U.S. and Worldwide -



YAHOO!

InsightExpress market research in July of 2001 has shown that:

"After years of slowly converging, the profile of the average adult American Internet user looks like the profile of the average American, according to online market research firm InsightExpress.

The demographic shift -- from early adopters of new technology who are young, relatively wealthy and predominantly male, to average Americans -- is important because it validates the Internet as a mainstream marketing, advertising and research platform.

Though Internet users still have a moderately higher average household income, the Internet has been adopted by nearly every segment of the U.S. population."

The U.S. population is realizing the potential of the computer and the Internet as a component to help make their lives easier.

StatisticalResearch.com reports that:

*"**Westfield, New Jersey, May 22, 2001:** It has been just half a year since Statistical Research, Inc. (SRI) last mapped the home technology landscape -- yet in that short time several key Internet devices and services have gained substantial ground among consumers.*

According to the Spring 2001 Ownership Report from The Home Technology Monitor™, 15% of all U.S. households now have a cellular phone or personal digital

assistant (PDA) capable of sending/receiving email or accessing the Internet – an increase of 50% over the Fall 2000 figure.

In addition, the proportion of households with broadband Web access – via a cable modem or digital subscriber line (DSL) – has nearly doubled in the past six months, from 3% in Fall 2000 to 9% in the new study. At the same time, the proportion of on-line homes using a telephone line to access the Internet fell six percentage points, from 89% to 83%.

The report also shows that, compared to all on-line homes, those with broadband are almost 50% more likely to have made an on-line purchase, while those with mobile Web access are slightly less likely to have bought on-line."

The home is gradually being modified into an extension of the Internet. Homeowners are using their PC's and handhelds for more conveniences then just surfing the Internet and this requires a greater amount of Internet speed. The U.S. homes are gradually becoming more technologized for the coming of future technologies.

The Internet Service Providers (ISP) are starting to move towards more home services at shown in this chart from CyberAtlas.com on June 14th, 2001:

Planned Value-Added Service Deployments by ISPs	
Online gaming	15%
Streaming media	39%
Web site services (e.g., hosting, co-location, e-commerce)	80%
Business services (finance, HR, ERP, etc.)	36%
Communication services (IP telephony, messaging, e-mail)	72%
Infrastructure services (application infrastructure, managed security)	31%
Other	3%

Source: CyberAtlas Research Index

Industry Findings:

These facts and figures show us that the economy and customers are moving steadily towards the Internet as a medium for purchasing everyday items and services. What we are seeing is the adoption of the computer in all levels of every day activities and the development of the completely computerized home. Companies such as GE and Creston are developing new high-tech products that will allow complete control of the home from your PC and handheld devices whether you are at home or on the road. An interface between all of this new hardware and the typical homeowner services needs to be developed. That is where CES will step in.

It would be a bold statement to say that the size of the market is every home in America, but when you look at the facts, every home will need a product that can manage the household simplistically and tie in with the Internet and all of your household appliances. There is an increasing demand for home automation products as the public gradually becomes more aware of what is being offered and as the prices are decreasing rapidly. We see companies like X10 with a tremendous advertising campaign, putting up ads on practically every popular web site. X10 offers simple home automation hardware and we can see that the public is aware of this trend and heading that direction by the efforts of X10.

The beauty of what CES is offering is a new generation of Internet business. The approach to bringing this software to the public will be key as well as our use of capital. With any business, a proper business plan and economic forecasts will help to guide us in our use and pursuit of further funding. There will be some initial high capital costs, but the production costs will initially be quite reasonable as this technology is very easy to build and design. After the initial testing stage, our marketing costs will be high as we pursue acceptance among consumers and increase the recognition of our product, but our sales within a short amount of time will be able to offset these costs. Our biggest barrier will be in which direction to pursue this market as releasing it to a small community will bring attention from competitors looking to imitate and sell a similar product.

There will be various changes in technology and consumer understanding in the near future. What has kept many of the IT companies in business is a strong community of visionaries and individuals willing to take a chance based upon clever theories. The Internet was born out of vision and continues to move forward as a vision. We are lucky that we now have facts, figures and history to base our plan upon, but we should never underestimate the dreams and ideas of the individuals involved in this undertaking.

Product

The major product that CES will initially offer is the contractor services. This will allow customers to purchase all of there household needs quickly and easily from the Internet and allow bill paying to be simplified. Allowing our customers to be able to control all of their services for the family, home, auto, etc. will be our key feature. Finally there will be

a service that allows the computer to be used as efficiently as it was designed to be. The consumer no longer has to spend hours searching for the best service providers and doesn't have to worry about bill paying day and sitting down at the table with the checkbook and a stack of invoices. Everything else is becoming so simplistic in life, why can't our home surroundings be just as simple.

The consumers in the United States today are becoming savvier with their home computer as we see a huge increase in PC sales each quarter. Homeowners want the opportunity to surf the Internet, send and receive email and balance their checkbook. These consumers see the value of the home computer as they use it from day to day. They realize the future of the computer and how it can benefit them. The problem with the computer has been it's limitations and the industries narrow focus and producing one useless piece of software after another, which has not allowed the production of actual software that makes the computer a timesaving device. CES's product will be intriguing to the initial audience, as these homeowners finally see a computer program that brings together many aspects of home ownership, and the home computer.

Customers

The test stages of this service will allow us to recognize the demographics and customers that we should be initially targeting. The typical household that will be able to use this product will most likely be any household with a medium to above average income that use services such as: landscapers, pool cleaners and house cleaners. Our ability to identify such customers will allow for a very specific marketing campaign.

U.S. Bureau of Labor Statistics reports that:

"Landscape Services employees increased from 308,000 in 1991 to 526,000 in 2000."

This future of the household cleaning industry in a report by the U.S. Building Maintenance Services Industry: National Trends and Characteristics, An Initial Report for the Center of Competitive Analysis, August 2000, said:

"Further gains in the residential market will be fueled by rising home ownership and an increase in the number of dual-income families, who have less time available for household cleaning. In addition, as noted above, the industry is clearly dominated by small businesses."

What better way to help fuel small businesses then bringing them more clientele? Granted, a lot of these small businesses will probably grow into larger ones, but that will depend on how CES will work with its contractors. Should we have a smaller amount of larger contractors to service our customers or a large amount of smaller contractors dedicated to providing quality service? We should always consider the quality of each aspect of the business. Nothing creates more customers then word-of-mouth and a happy customer can increase your business 10-fold. The future of this company will rely upon

customer feedback and their ideas as every individual, in today's society, can usually find a problem with the services that they receive.

Competition

The major service that CES is offering, contractor brokering, has no competition to speak of, as there is currently no other company offering this type of service. The future business ideas will find competition in the marketplace as many of these Internet services have been around for many years. As we have seen with Yahoo, they have grown from a basic search engine to becoming a source of online shopping, bill paying, stock research, career and employment classifieds, maps, yellow pages and the basics of News, Sports and Weather.

Online businesses have made the Internet a way of ignoring people and not responding to problems or e-mail as customer service can claim that they never received any communication. This is a problem that definitely needs to be fixed. What happened to the customer is always right? What happened to the employee that would go out of his/her way to make a customer happy and comfortable? The way we use these ideas is how we will make our customer base grow and this is how we will stand out and penetrate the market.

Some of the biggest current questions CES has now are:

How do we make it so that the competition cannot come up to speed with our plan quickly? Can we create a patent for this?

How do we prevent competition initially? We cannot create a monopoly so how do we create a business solution that others would buy, possibly franchise?

Can we take this technology, after our confidential test marketing stage, to companies such as Yahoo or Crestron to develop a partnership?

There is so much potential for what we are offering that planning our strategy will be essential in our infancy as we race to out-think our competition.

What products and companies will compete with you?

Niche

"What ever happened to the customer is always right"

"Your home and your surroundings finally controlled by you. The Internet that actually accomplishes something."

"Though the fog of the Internet, there appears a guiding light"

These are examples of our initial advertising quotes to introduce a company that is built upon a new level of ethics and values. We no longer want people to look at Internet business as a technology but as a staple in our everyday existence.

Strategy

The question that we must ask ourselves every day of business is:

"How can we bring the various aspects of the Internet together to form a product that is as simple to use as an ATM and gives us as much information as the Library of Congress?"

Promotion

Advertising can be a major cost of doing business which is why we believe that creative thought can help us to market our product in it's initial introduction in order to save money. Larger TV and Radio advertising campaigns will be essential in the future as we bring this service to the mass market.

Word-of-mouth advertising, as we have described earlier, will be very beneficial to our growth and our image will need to be spotless. Our placement on the search engines will be necessary but will do little in bringing in new business. The best methods for bringing in new customers will be limited partnerships with companies where their customers could use our services. Companies like our Landscape and House Cleaning contractors that are already advertising within the market that we are looking to bring in. Their door-knob flyers, yellow page ads and newspaper advertisements can hold our company name and web-site and help to promote our business while continually bringing new business their way.

We will get news companies and magazines to feature our new business Grand Opening and it's ideas. We will do mass emailing to selective clientele, allowing them the opportunity to be the first involved with a new way of doing business.

A company logo that is easy to recognize was how Maroone brought his new advertising campaign to the public weeks before they new what the stand alone logo meant.

Promotional Budget

Very small budget during trial stages.
Significant budget during product release to general public.

Pricing

There is no competition at the moment so we will have to look at other computer services to plan our pricing strategy. Bill Paying services charge between $2.95 and 5.95 per month. Your typical phone line Internet service, like America Online, is $21.95 per month. A good portion of the computer owning population is now taking advantage of the new high speed Internet access and is spending $39.95 to $59.95 per month. Our pricing will have to be reasonable as your homeowner is spending a premium for the high-speed access and probably is not looking to spend more money on some new computer technology. A price of $9.95 a month would fit well into anybody's budget. A

30-day free trial policy, similar to what most Internet Service Providers offer, will be available. If a customer is unhappy with our service at any time and wishes to be credited or cancel there service, we will automatically allow a credit of one month to be made by our billing personnel and higher credits will have to be authorized by management. A customer that receives the credit that they feel they deserve will be more likely to consider there business with us as a pleasant experience.

Proposed Location